

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

Asset allocation and multi-asset risk professional seeking the Principal, Overlay Management role, with ~7 years across institutional ALM, tactical and strategic asset allocation, derivatives-based hedging, and stochastic scenario analysis. Built VaR/CVaR optimization and risk-decomposition analytics linking macro regimes to equity returns, correlations, and funding-ratio drawdowns for pension-fund clients at Ortec Finance; extended that work into stress and reverse-stress scenario frameworks at Moody's Analytics, where I hold delegated sign-off on multi-asset institutional portfolio outputs. CFA + dual MSc (Financial Modelling; Chemical Engineering).

CORE SKILLS

Tactical Asset Allocation (TAA) & Strategic Asset Allocation (SAA) • Multi-Asset Portfolio Construction & Risk-Adjusted Return Decomposition • Macroeconomic Regime Analysis & Equity Risk Signals • Derivatives: Interest-Rate, FX & Inflation (Swaps, Futures-analogous overlays) • Tail Risk & Drawdown Analysis via Stress & Scenario Testing • VaR / CVaR Optimization & Risk Budgeting • Stochastic Modelling & Monte Carlo Simulation • Python (Advanced), SQL (Intermediate) • Investment-Committee Presentation & Governance Communication

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director - Modelling Services (Investment & ALM Risk Lead) | Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Multi-Asset Analytics & Investment-Committee Output

- Hold delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and multi-asset portfolio outputs delivered to institutional client portfolios ranging \$5-25bn per engagement – cumulatively ~\$50bn of institutional assets across the book.
- Review curve construction, spread calibration, and cross-asset interactions, translating market dynamics into defensible portfolio-level sensitivities prior to production release.
- Validate derivatives pricing outputs across rates, FX, and inflation, ensuring sensitivity and scenario consistency at portfolio-level aggregates.

Stress Testing, Scenario Analysis & Drawdown Visibility

- Led design and implementation of an enterprise multi-asset cash flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios – providing forward-looking drawdown and liquidity visibility across ALM horizons.
- Architected configurable time-bucketed exposure analytics (T+1 through multi-year) enabling rebalancing-trigger assessment, refinancing risk evaluation, and tactical allocation decisions under stressed regimes.
- Embedded behavioral cash flow assumptions, prepayment logic, and macro stress overlays aligned with institutional drawdown management and contingency-planning expectations.

Governance, Stakeholder Communication & Team Development

- Serve as escalation point for client-critical analytical issues; interface directly with Heads of Risk and investment stakeholders, articulating portfolio sensitivities and risk-return trade-offs to senior decision-makers.
- Re-engineered manual workflows into auditable Python analytics pipelines; deployed agentic AI development workflows (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) reducing development cycle time by an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.
- Mentor junior analysts on portfolio construction, scenario analysis, and model governance, supporting team resilience and disciplined decision-making.

Client Service Specialist - Buy-Side Solutions | Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Onboarded U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms onto a multi-asset analytics platform; advised clients on asset, liability, and total-portfolio configurations.
- Translated investment-team requirements into product and development scope; validated model outputs across fixed-income, derivatives, and multi-asset positioning post-deployment.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant - IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation | Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients, aligning regulatory requirements with financial-reporting and risk frameworks.
- Coordinated across actuarial, finance, IT, risk, and program-management teams on milestone delivery, governance documentation, and implementation materials.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant - Asset-Liability Management & Risk | Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Advised Canadian and international pension funds on Strategic and Tactical Asset Allocation, evaluating return objectives, duration alignment, and drawdown tolerance through stress testing and sensitivity analysis.
- Built and interpreted stochastic economic scenario generators linking macroeconomic regimes to equity returns, correlations, and funding-ratio volatility under base-case and stressed environments.
- Performed asset-only and surplus (asset-liability) portfolio optimization on VaR and CVaR via Ortec's GLASS platform, with risk decomposition (contribution-to-risk, risk budgeting) and near-optimal frontier robustness analysis to assess risk-adjusted return trade-offs across allocation scenarios.
- Designed multi-currency, inflation, and interest-rate hedging overlays for institutional mandates; modelled pension-fund liabilities alongside major investment-product types and economic variables.
- Led the ALM study for a three-plan university pension merger (now UPP) – on a team of three developing and validating the model capturing funding-policy dynamics and evaluating duration, currency, inflation, and leverage overlay strategies.
- Presented findings to investment committees on-site, articulating recommendations on asset allocation and overlay positioning to trustees and CIO-office stakeholders.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016